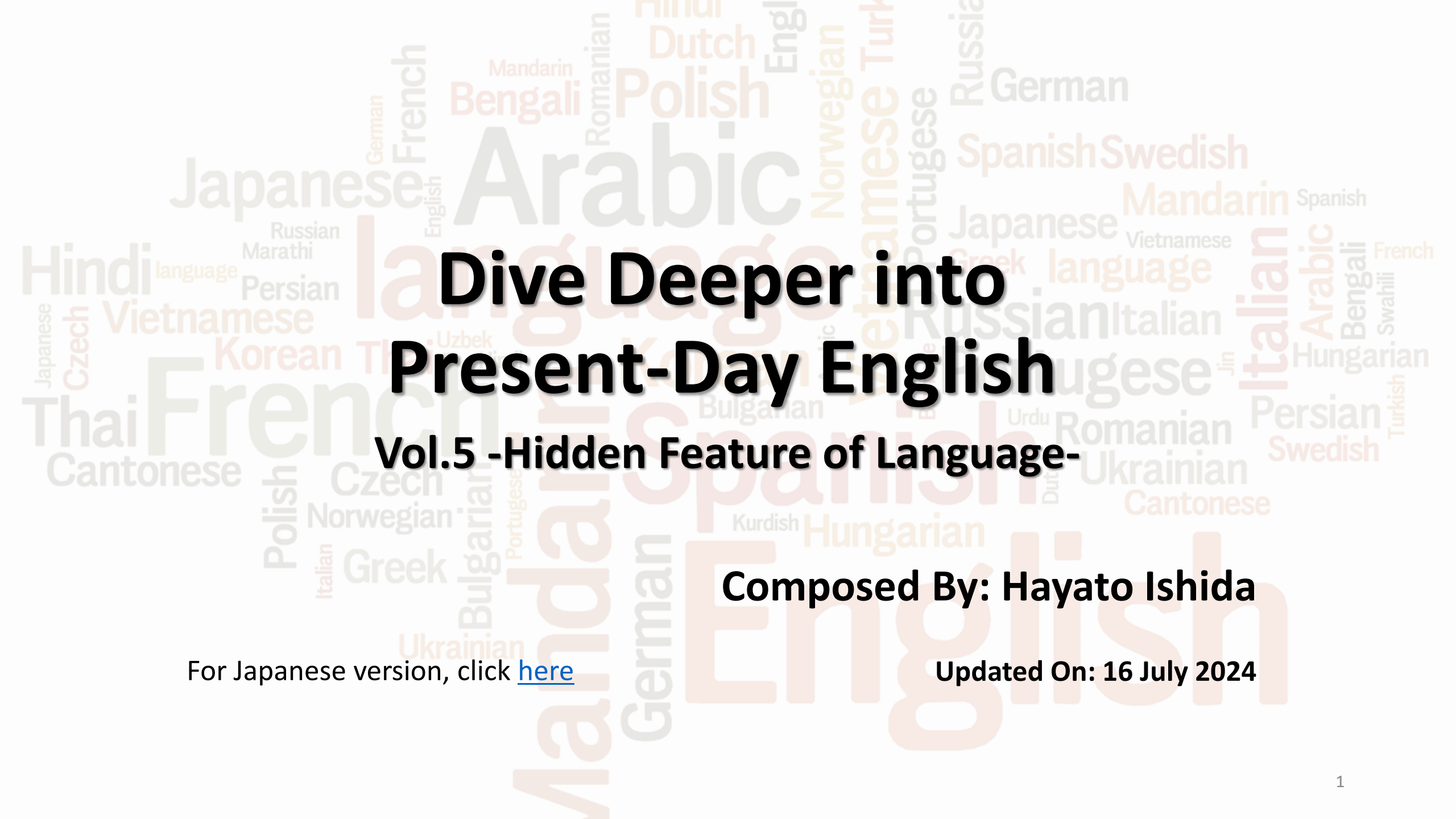




Dive Deeper into Present-Day English

Vol.5 -Hidden Feature of Language-

Composed By: Hayato Ishida

For Japanese version, click [here](#)

Updated On: 16 July 2024

About Me

- Accounts
 - GitHub: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
 - X: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
 - LinkedIn: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
 - Speaker Deck: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
 - Docswell: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
- Occupation: Software Engineer
- Things I Am Into
 - Linguistics
 - Singing at Karaoke
 - Listening to Music
 - Watching Movies
 - Cat Feeding



Licences / Certifications

- English
 - TOEIC® Listening & Reading 915: Certified on December 2019
- Engineering
 - Information Security Management: Certified on November 2017
 - Applied Information Technology Engineer: Certified on June 2017
 - Fundamental Information Technology Engineer: Certified on November 2016
 - IT Passport: Certified on April 2016
- Others
 - Abacus 2nd Class: Certified on June 2002
 - Mental Arithmetic 3rd Class: Certified on February 2001

Skill Stack

- Languages
 - Japanese: Native Proficiency
 - English: Full professional Proficiency
- Development
 - **Backend:** Ruby(Ruby on Rails), Python
 - Frontend: TypeScript + React.js, TypeScript +Vue.js
 - **Database:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
 - **Architecture:** Monolith, Modular Monolith
 - Hosting: AWS ESK
 - Versioning: Git, GitHub
 - **CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, ArgoCD
 - Monitoring: Datadog, Sentry

Work Histories

Period	Genre	Position	Jobs
Aug 2021 - Present	SaaS(Educational Service)	Software Engineer	• Backend Development • Frontend Development • CI/CD Maintenance • Weekly Release Manager • Troubleshooting • Documentation • Technical Debt Resolution • Tech Blog Entries • LT Speaker
Feb 2020 - Dec 2020	SaaS(Chatbot Platform)	Backend Engineer	• Backend Development • Documentation • Technical Debt Resolution • Inspection of Alternative API

Work Histories

Period	Genre	Position	Jobs
Jun 2018 - Jan 2020	Contract-basis Developer	Software Engineer	• Backend Development • Frontend Development • Troubleshooting • Quality Assurance • Tech Blog Entries
Apr 2016 - Jan 2018	System Engineering Service	System Engineer	• Corporate Account Admin • Windows Server Maintenance • Security Admin Assistant • Internationalisation / Localisation

International-Exchange Activities

- Activities in University
 - English Linguistics Seminar(Focusing on Mass Media English)
 - International-Exchange Clubs(The 2nd Year)
 - [International-Exchange Programmes conducted by Japan Cabinet Office](#)(2013 - 2016)
 - Japanese Linguistics Course(The Final Year)
- Overseas Life Experience
 - Working Holiday in Australia(April 2014 - March 2015)
 - Language School for 1 month in Sydney
 - Work for 6 Months in [Hamilton Island Resort](#)
 - Volunteering for 1 Month as Assistant Teacher of Japanese Language at [St Ives High School](#) in NSW
- Other Activities
 - Keep Everyday Journal in English (April 2014 - Present)
 - [Sunrise Toastmasters Club](#)(February 2017 - March 2018)
 - [Vital Japan](#)(January 2018 - July 2019, October 2022 - February 2023)
 - Self Learning and Training of English Language
 - Participation Ruby-Related Tech Conferences

Goals of This Series

- **To know how deep English Language is**
 - Not simply a communication tool
- **To know your own language by knowing another**
 - "He who knows no foreign languages knows nothing of his own." by Johann Wolfgang von Goethe
- **To pursue the essence that does not instantly but work later on**
 - Something which you think is meaningless has something genuine

Agenda

1. [Language Is a Culture](#)
2. [Language Is a Dress Code](#)
3. [Summary](#)
4. [Wrap-Up of This Series](#)
5. [References](#)

A word cloud featuring various world languages. The words are arranged in a circular pattern, with some languages appearing more frequently than others. The colors of the words range from light beige to dark brown. The central text '1. Language Is a Culture' is in a bold, black, sans-serif font.

1. Language Is a Culture

1. Language Is a Culture

Quote

How we address others depends on our relationships to them. My friends refer to me as Mike. However, many students refer to me as Prof. Geis or Dr. Geis or Mr. Geis, even though I usually encourage them to call me Mike. Some other American professors encourage this in order to signal a feeling of solidarity with students.

Nevertheless, the power difference between professors and students is large and many students feel more comfortable using a title plus the last name than just the first name. Oriental students who study in the United States normally feel very uncomfortable using just a professor's first name, at least at the beginning.

Reference: p.51 ll.10 - 20, Michael L. Geis, *Language and Communication*

1. Language Is a Culture

Top 4 Factors to Determine How You Address The Other

- Closeness
- Age
- Social Status
- Respect

1. Language Is a Culture

The Difference of Politeness between Western and Eastern Cultures

- Western Cultures
 - **To show friendliness**
 - Solidarity brings a psychological safety and boosts productivity via intense collaboration
 - → The other lets you call him/her in the first name to lower a psychological hurdle.
- Eastern Cultures
 - **To keep the best psychological distance**
 - Japanese language expresses the concept via **exalted**, **humble** and **polite** terms.
 - → We maintain a strain relation with the other with a careful language.

1. Language Is a Culture

How Asians Adapt to the Western Culture

- **Phase 1: Psychological Conflict between the Western and their Own Cultures**
 - Politeness: To show friendliness vs. To keep the best psychological distance
 - Particularly, Asians think of calling someone superior without title as a rude behaviour.
- **Phase 2: Acquisition of the Western Language**
 - Experience the western culture via the language
 - Language conflicts = Cultural conflicts fill the gaps.
- **Phase 3: Adaptation to the Western Culture**
 - Receive cardiac output of the cultural differences
 - Reflect the understanding to the language and speech
 - → Hesitation to call someone else in their first name will be gone.

Acquisition and Adaptation of the language and culture rebuild their identities.

A word cloud featuring various languages in different sizes and colors (shades of orange, red, and grey). The languages include Arabic, Spanish, English, French, Japanese, Hindi, Vietnamese, Korean, Thai, Cantonese, Polish, Czech, Norwegian, Greek, Bulgarian, Portuguese, Ukrainian, German, Italian, Russian, Mandarin, Bengali, Persian, Urdu, Romanian, Hungarian, Swedish, Persian, Turkish, and many others. The word 'language' is also present in a smaller font. Overlaid on the word cloud is the title '2. Language Is a Dress Code' in a bold, black, sans-serif font.

2. Language Is a Dress Code

2. Language Is a Dress Code

Quote

When we go to a formal social gatherings, we normally wear more expensive and less comfortable clothes than when we plan to meet with close friends. While with friends, we wear clothes that are less expensive and more comfortable.

(snip) By wearing expensive clothes at formal gatherings, we show respect to those that we are with. By wearing less expensive, more comfortable clothes while with friends, we show solidarity with them.

(snip) The same is true of how we talk. By using more formal speech styles in more social gathering, we show respect to our listeners. By using less formal speech styles with our friends and intimates, we show solidarity with them.

Reference: p.59 - 60 ll.25 - 18, Michael L. Geis, *Language and Communication*

2. Language Is a Dress Code

Quote

(snip) How we talk reflects the social contexts we are in, and in casual speech contexts, not only we are free to use more casual forms, we must use them. Close friends might think we are playing a joke if we were to wear a tuxedo to an informal party. Similarly, if we were to use precise, careful speech with close friends, they would also think that we are playing a joke of some sort.

Reference: p.59 - 60 ll.25 - 18, Michael L. Geis, *Language and Communication*

2. Language Is a Dress Code

4 Types of Speech Styles

Speech Styles	Social Situations
Formal speech style	Formal social gathering, Dinner, Funeral, Ceremony
Consultative speech style	Meeting at work, Lecture at university, Union with someone new
Casual speech style	Casual gathering together with someone you know well
Intimate style	Private gathering together with someone you are very close to

2. Language Is a Dress Code

Social Situations and Behaviours

Social Situations	Dress	Speech Styles	Signs
Formal Social Gatherings	• Expensive • Uncomfortable • Physically Costly	• Precise Pronunciation • Precise Grammar and Collocations • Mentally costly	Politeness Respect
Casual Gatherings with Close Friends	• Reasonable • Comfortable • Physically Uncostly	• Casual Pronunciation • Casual Grammar and Collocations • Mentally Uncostly	Friendliness Solidarity

→ We must comply with protocol based on the time, place and occasion by paying attention to what speech style we employ just as what clothes we get dressed in.

3. Summary

1. Language Is a Culture

- We experience another culture via another language.
- We adapt to another culture after we overcome cultural conflicts.
- Cultural understanding is reflected on the languages and speech we use.

2. Language Is a Dress Code

- Costly speech styles and dresses represents politeness and respect to the other.
- Uncostly speech styles and dresses represents friendliness and solidarity to the other.
 - → The share the same criteria in terms of protocol based on the time, places and occasions.

A word cloud featuring various languages. The words are arranged in a circular pattern, with some languages appearing more frequently than others. The colors of the words range from light beige to dark brown. The central text is in a bold, black font.

4. Wrap-Up of This Series

4. Wrap-Up of This Series

The 5 presentations were given to achieve the following 3 goals.

- **To know how deep English Language is**
 - Not simply a communication tool
- **To know your own language by knowing another**
 - "He who knows no foreign languages knows nothing of his own." by Johann Wolfgang von Goethe
- **To pursue the essence that does not instantly but work later on**
 - Something which you think is meaningless has something genuine

4. Wrap-Up of This Series

We rarely find something inconvenient when we speak our own mother tongue in our daily lives, so we do not have care about the points mentioned in this series.

However, we cannot avoid being aware of them especially when we learn another language or go into another culture.

The first hurdle we are supposed to encounter is the wall of language.

Basically, we can acquire so-called 4 skills, listening, reading, writing and speaking provided we are allowed to spend enough time to learn another language.

4. Wrap-Up of This Series

The most difficult is to correctly understand cultural differences and adapt to them, in which process we strongly become aware of our own language and culture.

"He who knows no foreign languages knows nothing of his own." is a famous proverb we all should keep in mind; in other words, "He who knows no other cultures knows nothing of his own."

Learning another language means pulling a trigger to know more about our own language, culture and history.

Nothing could be a great honour if this series offers you a chance to think about it.

5. References

- Michael L. Geis, *Language and Communication*, Oxford, OUP, 2001
- [Dictionary.com](https://www.dictionary.com)
 - Last Accessed On: 21 October 2021

